DIMITRIS ZOPOUNIDIS

PhD Candidate | Business Analytics & Data-Driven Strategic Decision Intelligence (Data-to-Decision)
Researcher at the Data Science Laboratory - DS Lab, Technical University of Crete
University Campus, 73100, Chania, Crete, Greece
dzopounidis [at] tuc.gr | Office tel. +30 28210 06136
https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=Sg7_E-gAAAAJ
https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Dimitris-Zopounidis
https://dimitriszopounidisdslab.github.io/zopounidis-analytics/
https://dimitriszopounidisdslab.github.io/zopounidis-group/

ACADEMIC PROFILE

Dimitris Zopounidis is a PhD Candidate at the **Data Science Laboratory - DS Lab** of the Technical University of Crete and a researcher specializing in Business Analytics, Artificial Intelligence (AI), Data Science, and Data-Driven Strategic Decision Intelligence. He is also affiliated with the Business Administration Sector of the Department of Economics at Aristotle University of Thessaloniki (AUTh) and the Fintech & Strategic Artificial Intelligence (FTSAI) Laboratory at the University of Macedonia.

His work focuses on the use of analytics and data-driven approaches to support strategic decision-making, governance, sustainability, and organizational transformation.

Combining academic research with real-world applications, he is actively involved in large-scale strategic projects across the banking, tourism, hospitality, and aviation sectors. He serves as Researcher on strategic initiatives developed in collaboration with **Alpha Bank**, including large-scale studies supporting strategic intelligence, economic development, data-driven decision-making, and evidence-based policymaking.

As Founder and Head of Research of the **Crete Aviation Observatory (CAO)**, one of Greece's leading independent aviation research initiatives, he leads empirical research on aviation analytics, sustainability, passenger behavior, and tourism-air transport dynamics. Through his academic, research, and industry engagements, he contributes to the transformation of data into actionable insights that support strategy development, organizational performance, and evidence-based decision-making.

His research interests include Business Analytics, Artificial Intelligence, Strategic Intelligence, AI governance, AI risk management, sustainability assessment, aviation analytics, banking research, financial analytics and data-driven decision-making.

EDUCATION

October 2025 - October 2028

PhD Candidate, Data Science Laboratory - DS Lab
School of Production Engineering and Management
Technical University of Crete, Chania, Greece

March 2024 - June 2025

MSc in Business Analytics and Data Science
Department of Business Administration
University of Macedonia, Thessaloniki, Greece

September 2019 - June 2023

BSc in Business Administration
Department of Business Administration
University of Macedonia, Thessaloniki, Greece

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical University of Crete - Data Science Laboratory (DS Lab)
Researcher and PhD Candidate | Nov 2023 - Present

Alpha Bank
Researcher | May 2026 - Present
Data-Driven Strategic Intelligence and Data-to-Decision Analytics Study
Large-scale strategic initiative supporting economic development, strategic intelligence, evidence-based decision-making, and policymaking for pathway to growth

Artificial Intelligence Risk Management Researcher | Apr 2026 - Present
Development of AI Risk Management Methodologies aligned with the EU AI Act and responsible AI governance practices.

Crete Aviation Observatory (CAO)
Founder & Head of Research | Nov 2021 - Present
Independent research initiative focused on aviation analytics, sustainability, and air transport development.

Crete Tourism Observatory
Coordinator, Researcher & Data Analyst | Aug 2020 - Present
Supporting tourism intelligence, data analysis, and evidence-based decision-making for tourism stakeholders.

SeaCrete Hotels
Airport & Aviation Data Analyst | Aug 2025 - Present

Hania Hotels Association
Airport & Aviation Data Analyst | Sep 2025 - Present

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Technical University of Crete
Teaching Assistant, Master of Business Administration (MBA) Program | May 2026 - Present

CIHEAM MAICh
Teaching Assistant, Financial Management Laboratory | March 2025 - Present

SCIENTIFIC COMMUNICATION & KNOWLEDGE DISSEMINATION

aviationlife.gr
Founder & Editor-in-Chief | Dec 2020 - Present

Air Letter Magazine - Hellenic Aviation Society
Editorial and Content Officer | Sep 2022 – Present

PUBLICATIONS

Sifakis, N., Zopounidis, D., Doumpos, M., & Zopounidis, K. (2026). Stakeholder-anchored multi-criteria deployment of island hybrid renewable energy systems for lifecycle carbon reduction: A weight-robustness analysis. *Journal of Cleaner Production, 580*, 149690. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2026.149690

Research contribution: Contributed to data curation, quantitative analysis, and visualization in a multi-criteria decision analysis (MCDA) framework integrating Random Forest, TreeSHAP, CRITIC, and TOPSIS to evaluate 14 hybrid renewable energy configurations for Crete. The study assesses

decision robustness under alternative weighting schemes and identifies energy solutions with significant lifecycle carbon reduction potential.

MEMBERSHIPS & RESEARCH NETWORKS

EURO Working Group on Multiple Criteria Decision Aiding (EWG-MCDA)
Member | *September 2026 - Present*

Financial Engineering & Banking Society (FEBS)
Member | *September 2020 - Present*

EUROPEAN RESEARCH PROJECTS

Sust-HEIn (University of Macedonia)
Researcher / Data Analyst | *October 2024 – December 2024 & April 2025 – August 2025*

AquaSphere (Technical University of Crete)
Researcher / Data Analytics Lead | *April 2026 – Present*

BOOKS

Artificial Intelligence and Applications in Management
Constantin Zopounidis, Dimitris Zopounidis, Angelos Kostis.
Barbounakis Publications, 2024.

HONORS AND AWARDS

2026 - Award of Excellence (3rd Place), SkyImpact Challenge
Heraklion International Airport, Crete
Recognised among the **top three teams** in the SkyImpact Challenge for an innovative proposal supporting the future development of the New Heraklion International Airport.

PRESENTATIONS AT CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

102nd Meeting of the EURO Working Group on Multiple Criteria Decision Aiding (EWG-MCDA)
"Airport Sustainability Assessment: A PROMETHEE-Based Methodology and a Case Study for Greek Airports"
Poster presentation | Zürich, Switzerland, 17–19 September 2026

Joint Session: Technical University of Crete and the Royal Academy of Economic and Financial Sciences (RACEF)

"AI Adoption by SMEs and Inclusive Regional Development in Island Economies: Drivers, Impacts, and Policy Implications"
Presentation | Chania, Crete, Greece, April, 23 2026

15th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)

"Evaluating the ESG Efficiency of Global Airlines: A DEA-Based Approach"

National and Kapodistrian University of Athens (NKUA), Athens, Greece, December, 18 - 19 2025

7th Hellenic Aviation Society Conference

"An Empirical Analysis of the Relationship Between Corporate Financial Performance and ESG Factors in the Airline Sector"

Sofitel Athens Airport Hotel, Athens, Greece, June, 5 – 6 2025

14th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)

"An Empirical Analysis of the Relationship Between Corporate Financial Performance and ESG Factors in the Airline Sector"

Athens University of Economics and Business, Athens, Greece, December, 19 - 20 2024

12th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)

"Financial Cyber Risk Analysis: The Case of the Aviation Industry II"

University of West Attica, Athens, Greece, December, 19 - 20 2022

11th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)

“Financial Cyber Risk Analysis: The Case of the Aviation Industry I”

American College of Greece, Athens, Greece, December, 20 - 21 2021

PARTICIPATIONS

8th Summer Conference on Financial Intermediation and Corporate Finance
Participant | Athens, Greece, June 30, 2026

LCA Training School - Multiple View Life Cycle Sustainability Assessment
Participant | COST Action CA23157 - MultiViewLCSA
Thessaloniki, Greece | September, 6 - 11, 2026